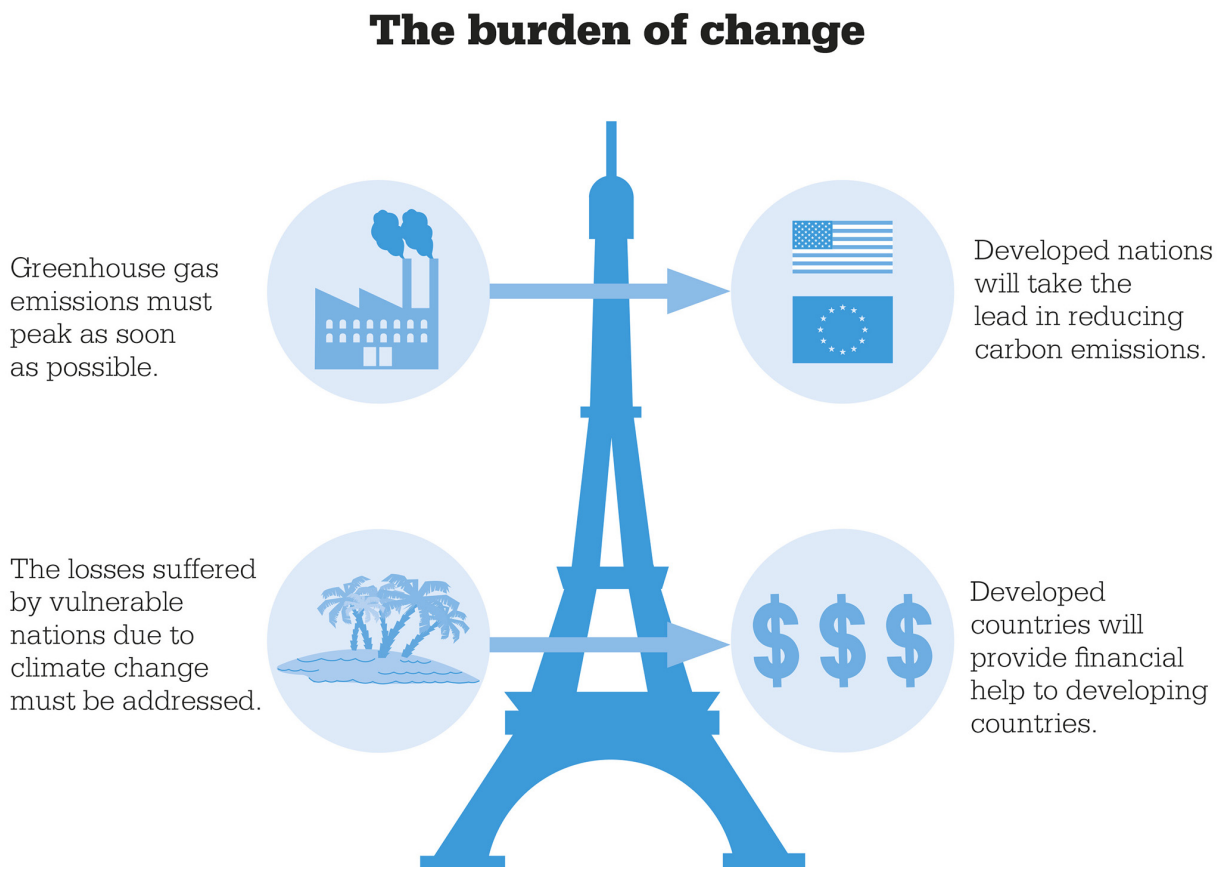


The Paris Agreement was signed by 195 member countries of the UNFCCC. It placed the responsibility on developed nations to assist those who lacked the funds or resources to combat climate change alone.

Read accessible description

Desperate measures

According to the terms of the Paris Agreement, countries must work together to limit the increase in the global average temperature to below 2°C (3.6°F) above pre-industrial levels. The agreement also seeks to go further, suggesting that the increase should be limited to only 1.5°C (2.7°F). In a study published in the journal *Earth System Dynamics* in 2016, climate scientist Carl-Friedrich Schleussner and his co-researchers argued that while an increase of 1.5 °C would create a global environment mirroring the